

Dishwashers, Disposals, Compactors and Cold Storage

How each one is fixed in place, how it is switched on, and the two temperatures.

YOU HAVE MISSED THIS 2 TIMES

A dishwasher is normally only mounted to the:
Countertop.

Two brackets at the top of the machine screw up into the underside of the counter. It is not fixed to the cabinets at the sides or to the floor, so it can be pulled out for service. Under a stone countertop it is bracketed to the side cabinets instead, because you cannot screw into stone.

The numbers here

Dishwasher width	24 in
Freezer setting	0 degrees Fahrenheit
Refrigerator setting	35 degrees Fahrenheit

YOU HAVE MISSED THIS 2 TIMES

A freezer should be set at:
Zero degrees Fahrenheit.

Zero for the freezer, thirty-five for the refrigerator. Both are well clear of the point where food spoils: the fridge sits just above freezing, the freezer well below it.

Switching

YOU HAVE MISSED THIS 2 TIMES

To activate a trash compactor, what is usually required?
A switch or a key.

A compactor crushes with enough force to be dangerous, so it does not simply run when the drawer closes. Either a switch has to be held or a key has to be turned — a deliberate act by an adult, the same principle as the garage door control height.

Garbage disposal

Its power cord requires a drip loop, and a disposal that makes no sound when switched on can often be restarted by pressing the thermal overload switch underneath it.

Dishwasher drain

Must have a high loop or an air gap, so waste water from the sink cannot siphon back into the machine.

Say it back

Cover the page. Answer each one out loud.

1. What is a dishwasher mounted to, and what changes under a stone counter?
2. Dishwasher width, freezer temperature, refrigerator temperature?
3. What does it take to activate a trash compactor, and why?
4. What does a disposal cord need, and what do you try on a silent disposal?
5. What stops sink water siphoning back into a dishwasher?